

ALL INDIA PUBLIC SECTOR HOCKEY TOURNAMENT 2024-25 HOSTED BY COAL INDIA LIMITED

**Canara Bank
Champions of AIPS
Hockey Tournament 2025,
Coal India Proves Best Host**

Headquartered in Kolkata, the Maharatna company Coal India Limited (CIL), operating under the aegis of the Ministry of Coal, successfully organized the four-day All India Public Sector Hockey Tournament 2024-25 from March 17 to 20, 2025. The event was conducted under the aegis of the All India Public Sector Sports Control Board (AIPSSCB), aligned with the 'Khelo India' mission at SAI Astro Turf, Kolkata. The SAI provided its world-class Astro Turf for the mega tournament, while Hockey Bengal extended technical support to ensure seamless match execution.

The event was organized by the Coal India Sports Promotion Association (CISPA), which aims to integrate sports as an essential element of CIL's ethos. The tournament saw Union Bank of India (UBI) and Canara Bank emerge as the two finalists after four days of intense competition at the SAI, Netaji Subhash Eastern Centre, Kolkata. For the



first time, Canara Bank clinched the championship title, while the host, Coal India Limited, won the hearts of players and hockey enthusiasts with its outstanding organizational efforts.

The four-day tournament was inaugurated by Shri P.M. Prasad, Chairman, Coal India Limited, who kicked off the event by scoring a ceremonial goal, met with cheers from dignitaries, players, and spectators alike.

In his inaugural speech, Shri P.M. Prasad remarked, "Sports unite beyond competition, fostering teamwork, discipline, and excellence. This hockey event, with the participation of PSUs, showcases not just skill and determination but also the spirit of camaraderie

and sportsmanship." He further emphasized that the tournament provides an excellent platform for showcasing the true spirit of hockey.

A vibrant cultural program marked the inauguration, featuring a parade of all participating teams along with their managers and captains. The tournament trophy was unveiled by Shri P.M. Prasad, Dr. Vinay Ranjan, and other dignitaries

in a grand ceremony.

The prestigious event was graced by several dignitaries, including :

- ◆ Dr. Vinay Ranjan, Director (P&IR), CIL & President, AIPSSCB
- ◆ Shri Mukesh Chowdhary, Director (Marketing), CIL
- ◆ Shri Achyut Ghatak, Director (Technical), CIL
- ◆ Shri Brajesh Kumar Tripathy, CVO, CIL
- ◆ Shri O.P. Dani, Treasurer, AIPSSCB
- ◆ Shri Ramesh Sachdeva, Consultant, AIPSSCB
- ◆ Shri Victor Anthony, Selector, AIPSSCB
- ◆ Shri Loknath Sahu, General Manager, UBI
- ◆ Executive Directors, General Managers, and HODs from CIL Headquarters